



कर्मचारी भविष्य निधि संगठन

(श्रम मंत्रालय भारत सरकार)

Employees' Provident Fund Organisation

(Ministry of Labour, Govt. Of India)

मुख्य कार्यालय / Head Office

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No. Coord.40/ (1)/2013/VIP Reference/Pt.

Dated:

To,

All Addl. CPFCs (HQ)/Addl. CPFCs/RPFCs,

08 OCT 2021

Sub:- Dealing with VIP references as per the established guidelines.

Ref:- Fourteenth edition of Central Secretariat Manual of Office Procedure

Madam/Sir,

A review meeting on the VIP references was held by Hon'ble LEM on 31.08.2021. Most of the VIP references reviewed were received from Members of Parliament (MPs).

2. The communications received from MPs and other VIPs are to be dealt as per the established guidelines given in the fourteenth edition of Central Secretariat Manual of Office Procedure (Copy attached) circulated by DoPT. The guidelines are as follows:

"Para- 37: Correspondence with Members of Parliament and VIPs -

- (i) Communications received from Members of Parliament and VIPs should be attended to promptly.
- (ii) Where a communication is addressed to a Minister, it shall, as far as possible, be replied to by the Minister himself. In other cases, a reply should normally be signed by an officer of the rank of Secretary only.
- (iii) Where, however, a communication is addressed to the head of an attached or subordinate office, Public Sector Undertakings, Financial Institutions (including nationalized banks) Division/Branch In charge in a Ministry/Department /Organisation, shall be replied to by the addressee himself. In routine matters, he may send an appropriate reply on his own. In policy matters, however, the officer should have prior consultation with higher authorities before sending a reply. It should, however, be ensured that the minimum level at which such replies are sent to Members of Parliament and VIPs is that of Under Secretary and that also in letter form only.
- (iv) Normally information sought by a Member/VIP should be supplied unless it is of such a nature that it would have been denied to him even if asked for on the floor of the Houses of Parliament.
- (v) In case, a reference from an ex-Member of Parliament is addressed to a Minister or Secretary, reply to such reference may be sent by a joint

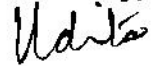
Secretary level officer after obtaining approval of the Secretary of the Ministry/Department. In case the reference is addressed to a lower level officer, reply to such reference could be sent by the officer on his own in non-policy cases and after obtaining approval of the higher authorities in policy cases,. However, the minimum level at which reply could be sent should be that of an Under Secretary and that too in a polite letter form only.

(vi) Each communication received from a Member of Parliament/VIP, shall be acknowledged within 15 days, followed by a reply within the next 15 days of acknowledgement sent.

(vii) Appropriate record shall be maintained in respect of communications received from Members of Parliament and VIPs and monitored by all concerned. A similar procedure may also be followed for judicial/quasi-judicial matters."

3. In the light of para 2(ii) above, a draft reply on behalf of Hon'ble LEM, may be submitted for his approval on e-file, along with complete facts of the case.

Yours faithfully,



(Udit Chowdhary)

Addl. CPFC (HQ) (Coordination)

CENTRAL SECRETARIAT
MANUAL
OF
OFFICE PROCEDURE

FOURTEENTH EDITION

MINISTRY OF PERSONNEL, PUBLIC GRIEVANCES AND PENSIONS
DEPARTMENT OF ADMINISTRATIVE REFORMS AND PUBLIC
GRIEVANCES

MAY 2015

(website: www.darpg.nic.in)

34. **Correspondence with Union Territory Administrations -** All communications of a routine nature which clearly relate to the business of a particular Department, shall ordinarily be addressed to the Secretary in the appropriate Department. Other important communications may be addressed to the Chief Secretary or the Administrator as the case may be.

35. **Correspondence with State Governments -**

(i) Communications on the subjects which clearly relate to the business of a particular Department shall normally be addressed to the Secretary of that Department. Other communications including those of special nature or importance warranting attention at higher levels may be addressed to the Chief Secretary. Demi-official letters may also be sent to officers of State Governments. In case of demi-official communication is to the Chief Secretary of a State, this level shall not be below the level of Joint Secretary.

(ii) Communications other than those of a purely routine nature e.g., acknowledgements shall not ordinarily be addressed to State Governments except with the prior approval and under the signature of the branch officer. Purely routine communications may, however, be signed by a Section Officer.

36. **Correspondence with the Lok Sabha and the Rajya Sabha Secretariats -**

Communications meant for the Lok Sabha Secretariat or the Rajya Sabha Secretariat and requiring urgent or high level attention shall be addressed to the Secretaries concerned and not to the Speaker or the Chairman directly.

37. **Correspondence with Members of Parliament and VIPs -**

(i) Communications received from Members of Parliament and VIPs should be attended to promptly.

(ii) Where a communication is addressed to a Minister, it shall, as far as possible, be replied to by the Minister himself. In other cases, a reply should normally be signed by an officer of the rank of Secretary only.

(iii) Where, however, a communication is addressed to the head of an attached or

subordinate office, Public Sector Undertakings, Financial Institutions (including nationalized banks) Division/Branch In charge in a Ministry/Department /Organisation, shall be replied to by the addressee himself. In routine matters, he may send an appropriate reply on his own. In policy matters, however, the officer should have prior consultation with higher authorities before sending a reply. It should, however, be ensured that the minimum level at which such replies are sent to Members of Parliament and VIPs is that of Under Secretary and that also in letter form only.

(iv) Normally information sought by a Member/VIP should be supplied unless it is of such a nature that it would have been denied to him even if asked for on the floor of the Houses of Parliament.

(v) In case, a reference from an ex-Member of Parliament is addressed to a Minister or Secretary, reply to such reference may be sent by a Joint Secretary level officer after obtaining approval of the Secretary of the Ministry/Department. In case the reference is addressed to a lower level officer, reply to such reference could be sent by the officer on his own in non-policy cases and after obtaining approval of the higher authorities in policy cases,. However, the minimum level at which reply could be sent should be that of an Under Secretary and that too in a polite letter form only.

(vi) Each communication received from a Member of Parliament/VIP, shall be acknowledged within 15 days, followed by a reply within the next 15 days of acknowledgement sent.

(vii) Appropriate record shall be maintained in respect of communications received from Members of Parliament and VIPs and monitored by all concerned. A similar procedure may also be followed for judicial/quasi-judicial matters.

38. Correspondence with Ministers of State Governments –

The procedure laid down in the above paragraph (No.37) shall also be followed in dealing with communications received from the Ministers of State Governments.